Unit 1 Section 5 – Entrepreneurs & Leaders: Exam Patterns & Trends (2019 → 2025)

Overview of Exam Patterns

- Breakdown of 2, 4, 6, 8, 10 and 20-mark questions.
- AO weighting & examiner focus shift towards AO4 (evaluation).
- Typical topics per mark band (e.g. 2 = definitions, 4 = explanations, 20 = extended evaluation).

Topic Trend Analysis (2019 – 2025)

Topic	Series Appeared	Command Words	Key Trend Summary
Role of Entrepreneur	2019 (Jun Q1c), 2021 (Jan Q2e), 2023 (Jan Q1a)	Define / Explain / Assess	Started as definition questions; recent focus on innovation and economic impact.
Characteristics & Skills	2020 (Jun Q1d), 2022 (Jan Q1b)	Explain / Discuss	More questions linking skills to leadership and decision making.
Motives & Barriers	2019 (Oct Q2b), 2021 (Jun Q2c), 2023 (Jan Q2a)	Explain / Assess / Discuss	Consistent appearance; barriers (especially finance) popular for 6–8 mark questions.
Business Objectives	2020 (Jan Q1e), 2022 (Jun Q1a), 2024 (Oct Q2b)	Explain / Evaluate	Shift towards CSR and SMART objectives evaluation.
Risk & Decision-Making	2020 (Jun Q3), 2021 (Oct Q1e), 2022 (Jan Q3)	Discuss / Evaluate	Core 20-mark focus each year – AO4 evaluation on risk-taking vs planning.

Predicted Focus for Jan 2026

Likely Focus	Mark Value	Question Type	Context Examples
Financial vs Non-Financial Motives	8	Discuss whether entrepreneurs are motivated more by money or achievement	Levi Roots, Sara Blakely
Risk vs Planning	20	Evaluate extent to which risk-taking is essential	Musk, Dyson, Roddick
Ethical Objectives	10	Evaluate whether CSR conflicts with profit	Patagonia, Ben & Jerry's
Leadership Skills	6–8	Assess importance of leadership in decision making	Branson, Roddick
Barriers to Entrepreneurship	6	Assess one barrier and how to overcome it	Virgin StartUp, Kickstarter

Teacher Revision Tips

- Retrieval starters → quick define/explain drills.
- 8-mark mini essays under timed conditions.
- Peer marking for AO4 judgement highlighting.
- "Entrepreneur context cards" for application.
- Mock exam rotation using 2026 predicted questions.

Key Messages

- At least one risk/objectives question appears every paper.
- AO4 (evaluation) marks increasing.
- Expect more "Assess" / "Evaluate" over "Explain."
- Named context (entrepreneurs) is essential for high AO2.